

Use Windows XP for a few weeks to verify that everything is working correctly. Once this is confirmed, go to Add or Remove Programs. Remove the option to revert to your old system. This will save on disk space, but be warned that there is no going back to your previous OS once you remove it.

1.8 Troubleshooting Startup And Shutdown Problems In XP

In the Windows family of operating systems, XP is by far the most reliable. Still, it's not without its problems, and there are chances of things going wrong. Startup and shutdown troubles are mostly due to incompatible hardware and software. Before getting down to troubleshooting, it is advisable to make sure your system has all the latest hardware device driver updates, patches and software programs updates that are XP-specific. At the minimum, you should run Windows Update and download all the latest patches. If you are not sure whether there is an update required for any device or software program, and are not sure where to start looking, don't worry—let's get on with the troubleshooting. We will eventually stumble across the offending device or program.

1.8.1 Troubleshooting startup problems

There are many sources of problems that could give you Startup troubles. These include (but are not limited to): defective, incompatible, or incorrectly configured hardware, incompatible (software) device drivers, or a recently installed program.

► **Problem:** Your screen remains blank when you switch on the PC.
Cause: That you are not able to even get the BIOS POST screen indicates a problem with basic hardware.

Solution: Look at the other sections in this guide. Work through the PSU, video card, and motherboard troubleshooting sections before checking the other components.